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Multimodal Literacy Narrative: Revision Memo

Although my multimodal literacy narrative first draft was mostly complete, after review I found that there were still some areas that were lacking. I felt that the overall structure and main content were sound. I used strong personal examples to demonstrate experiences with literacy through school, family, extracurriculars, and working. I used evidence from our text-based readings to support ideas such as my parents being literary sponsors as well as the connection between Vershawn Ashanti Young's discussion on code switching and my experiences with hockey. These sections made clear connections between course readings and my own literary experiences. However, there were still some areas which needed development in the essay.

I found that many of the examples present were strong, but there was not a present tie back to the main idea of literacy. This made the narrative lack some direction as it focused more on overall personal growth rather than specifically literary growth. For instance, the sections on Publix and Best Buddies focused heavily on communication but did not discuss how those experiences related to literacy itself. I went back and edited it to explain how these experiences built literacy skills such as reading conversation cues, tone, and body language. This further promoted literacy is more than just reading and writing within my narrative, pushing me to consider ideas such as interpersonal literacy, professional literacy, and adapting communication styles.

The most significant feedback I received on my narrative was that the multimodal component of my essay was lacking as the photos were not directly tied to the text. This allowed me to realize that I had included photos which were personally meaningful but did not explain their purpose within the essay. In response, I made sure the images were more intentionally integrated into the essay, explaining their meaning and how it ties to the main idea of literacy. I referenced what the image showed and connected it to the literary concepts being discussed. For instance, I clarified how certain images represented literacy development, communication, or identity formation. Rather than just inserting an image for decoration, I tried to make sure they increased the overall effectiveness of the essay.

Overall, I agreed with most of the feedback I received as it involved improving clarity and giving more meaning to the multimodal elements. The revised drafts more directly explain the purpose of images used and ties them into the written argument. In addition, deeper literary analysis was done on topics such as interpersonal communication and code switching, as opposed to just referencing these ideas. However, I intentionally kept the narrative feeling more personal and reflective as opposed to academic. Moving forward, I want to refine transitions between ideas and further polish sentence structure in order to improve the flow of the essay. Overall, the revision process substantially strengthened my essay and gave me a deeper understanding of multimodality and literacy.